

Nikolas Astra

IT Support Specialist | Technical Troubleshooting & Automation

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT Support Specialist with hands-on experience diagnosing and resolving hardware, software and network issues across macOS, Windows and Linux environments. Builds, upgrades and repairs systems and troubleshoots networks down to the component level. Brings a software and hardware development background (Python, C++, C#, full-stack MERN applications with secure authentication and payment integration, and microcontroller-based IoT automation) that enables faster root cause analysis, scripting and automation of routine tasks, and clear communication of complex issues to non-technical users.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Hardware & Peripherals: PC/laptop assembly, upgrades & repair, component level diagnostics, workstation setup and configuration

Operating Systems: Windows, macOS, Linux - support, troubleshooting, and installation/configuration

Networking: Network setup, router/connectivity troubleshooting, device configuration

Automation & IoT: Python scripting, Arduino/ESP microcontroller, Arduino Cloud, Alexa integration

Web Development: JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Express, HTML/CSS, REST APIs, JWT/bcrypt, Stripe, PayPal, Shopify Liquid

Databases: MongoDB, PostgreSQL

Languages & Tools: Python, C++, C#, Git, npm, Command Line

Design: Fusion 360, Adobe Creative Suite, TouchDesigner

Soft Skills: Technical troubleshooting under pressure, clear communication with non-technical users, documentation, cross-functional collaboration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer - Variable Z - Los Angeles, CA

2021 - Present

- Debug and maintain a live, customer-facing production platform handling real transactions, resolving issues across front-end, back-end, third-party integrations (Stripe, PayPal).
- Diagnose and resolve issues in authentication, order processing, and payment systems, identifying root causes and deploying fixes with minimal disruption
- Manage releases and deployments, applying structured testing and troubleshooting to maintain platform stability.

Freelance Full-Stack Developer - Remote

2020 - Present

- Deliver direct technical support to clients - gather requirements, diagnosing issues, and explaining solutions in plain, non-technical languages,
- Coordinate deployments and manage shared codebases using Git-based workflows
- Resolve ongoing technical and performance issues across multiple client projects.

UI Developer - SeePoint, LLC - Redondo Beach, CA

2019 - 2021

- Maintained and troubleshooted the company e-commerce website, resolving functional issues to keep the site running reliably.
- Developed and supported UI components for kiosk-based hardware systems, working at the intersection of hardware and software.

Computer Lab Technician - Woodbury University - Burbank, CA

2016 - 2018

- Delivered front-line technical support across Mac and Windows environments in high-traffic computer lab, resolving hardware, software, and network issues for students and staff.
- Diagnosed and triaged technical problems under time pressure, prioritizing issues to minimize user downtime.
- Maintained lab hardware and systems to ensure consistent uptime and reliability.

Interactive Design Intern - VirtuLabs - San Francisco, CA

2017

- Contributed to Project SkyLights installation presented at Digital Design Days + OFFF Milano.
- Integrated TouchDesigner with hardware systems for real-time visual experiences.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

Woodbury University - Burbank, CA